# WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

*Connecting International Capital*

# SURINAME

Americas

*Information current as of November 2026*

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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## WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

### KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

| Location / Region | Strategic Importance | Priority Sectors |
|---|---|---|
| Paramaribo | Capital and commercial centre; home to the Port of Paramaribo, the main banks and the national institutions that investors deal with | Trade, financial and business services, construction, logistics |
| Offshore Block 58 (GranMorgu) | TotalEnergies-operated development worth about $10.5 billion, with a 220,000 b/d FPSO and first oil targeted for 2028; Staatsolie holds up to 20% | Oil and gas, oilfield services, marine logistics |
| Offshore Block 52 (Sloanea) | Petronas-operated gas discovery declared commercial in November 2025; a floating LNG concept is planned, with first gas targeted for 2030 | LNG, gas services, engineering |
| Open offshore acreage | Staatsolie's open-door licensing programme offers more than 70,000 sq km across five exploration areas | Oil and gas exploration, seismic and drilling services |
| Merian gold mine (east) | Newmont (75%) and Staatsolie (25%) mine, around 66 km south of Moengo, producing about 300,000 ounces a year with production expected until at least 2042 | Gold mining, mining services, local supply |
| Interior gold belt and Rosebel | Gold is Suriname's leading export; Zijin's Rosebel mine and junior explorers anchor a wider mineral district | Gold exploration, mining equipment, responsible-mining services |
| Western Suriname (Bakhuis) | Largely undeveloped bauxite deposits for which the government has sought investors | Bauxite, mining infrastructure |
| Wanica and Zanderij | Kuldipsingh Port in Wanica and the Johan Adolf Pengel International Airport at Zanderij support cargo and passenger links | Port and airport logistics, warehousing, agro-processing |

### INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Suriname Investment and Trade Agency (SITA), the national investment promotion agency operating under the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, International Business and International Cooperation, acts as a one-stop shop for foreign investors

- Investment Law incentives including tax holidays of up to nine years (with a possible extension for large projects), import-duty exemptions on capital goods and accelerated depreciation
- Production-sharing contracts with Staatsolie, which holds petroleum rights, under an open-door offshore licensing programme
- Company registration through the Chamber of Commerce and Industry (KKF), with the N.V. (limited liability company) the most common structure
- Central Bank of Suriname (CBvS) oversight of a flexible exchange-rate regime for the Surinamese dollar; investors should confirm current transfer procedures for dividends and capital with the CBvS and their bank
- International protections including the New York Convention on foreign arbitral awards and MIGA membership, with Suriname pursuing the WTO Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement

### MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Suriname in November 2026 stands at the threshold of a transformational oil era, underpinned by a steady non-resource economy. The IMF estimates that non-resource GDP grew 4.4% in 2025 and projects overall growth of 3.9% in 2026, before offshore oil lifts growth to around 30% in 2028. Foreign direct investment rose to about $2.0 billion in 2025 from $675 million in 2024, according to UNCTAD data, driven by TotalEnergies' $10.5 billion GranMorgu project, which targets first oil in 2028, while Petronas plans a floating LNG development at Sloanea with first gas targeted for 2030. Suriname completed its IMF-supported programme in March 2025 and has legislated a strengthened Savings and Stabilization Fund (SSFS) and fiscal rules to manage future resource revenues, and inflation has eased to 7.3% in September 2026 from 13.0% at end-2025.

Suriname's main structural task is to consolidate macroeconomic stability in the years before oil revenues arrive. Fiscal and monetary slippages in 2025 widened the overall fiscal deficit to 10.0% of GDP and weakened the currency, while central government debt stood at an estimated 106% of GDP, mainly as a result of a liability management operation. The IMF has called for fiscal adjustment in 2026, projecting the deficit to narrow to 5.4% of GDP and debt to fall to about 96% of GDP, and gross reserves of $1.31 billion at end-2025 are projected to rise in 2026. The SSFS law, which channels all mineral revenue into an independently managed fund, together with the fiscal-rule framework provides the institutional base for converting oil income into lasting stability, and offers investors a clear policy anchor for the post-2028 period.

## INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

### KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

| Issue | Potential Impact | Possible Mitigation |
|---|---|---|
| Fiscal position and public debt | Central government debt was an estimated 106% of GDP in 2025 and the fiscal deficit widened to 10.0% of GDP, prompting IMF calls for adjustment in 2026 | The IMF projects debt falling to about 96% of GDP in 2026, with oil revenues from 2028 channelled through the SSFS and fiscal rules providing a path to sustained consolidation |
| Inflation and currency movements | Inflation returned to 13.0% at end-2025 and the Surinamese dollar weakened during 2025, though inflation eased to 7.3% by September 2026 | Apply standard hedging and dollar-denominated contracting where possible; the IMF supports continued exchange-rate flexibility and a new monetary policy framework |
| Pre-oil transition period | Large-scale oil revenues are not expected before 2028, and gold, which accounted for about 80% of exports in 2023, saw lower output in 2025 | Position early in oil-service supply chains and long-life assets such as Merian, which is expected to produce until at least 2042 |
| Governance and institutional capacity | Suriname ranked 88th of 180 on the 2024 Corruption Perceptions Index, and the IMF has recommended anti-corruption, procurement and AML reforms | Engage through SITA and Staatsolie, use international arbitration clauses and conduct robust due diligence and compliance checks |
| Readiness for first oil and local content | Industry participants have highlighted gaps in local readiness for first oil, and local content policy remains under development | Early partnerships with Surinamese suppliers, training programmes and engagement on local content policy can secure a lasting role in the supply chain |
| Small domestic market and absence of | Suriname has no designated special | Use Investment Law incentives and |

| Issue | Potential Impact | Possible Mitigation |
|---|---|---|
| SEZs | economic or free trade zones, and its domestic market is small | CARICOM market access, and track government interest in establishing special economic zones |
| Land access and interior communities | Mining expansion depends on permits, land access and relations with interior communities, where small-scale gold mining is widespread | Build community agreements and mercury-free mining initiatives, following the Merian model, into project design from the outset |

### INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Suriname's risk profile reflects a small economy on the verge of a major resource transition, with a sound non-resource growth base and a clear institutional framework for managing future oil wealth. The 2025 fiscal and monetary slippages raised debt and inflation, but inflation has since eased to 7.3% and the IMF projects narrowing deficits and falling debt from 2026. The SSFS law and fiscal rules adopted in December 2024 give investors visibility on how oil revenues from 2028 will be managed. Governance and institutional capacity remain areas of ongoing reform, so investors should conduct thorough due diligence and use international arbitration protections. For investors with a medium-term horizon, the period before first oil offers an opportunity to establish partnerships and supply-chain positions ahead of a sharp expansion in activity.

### MARKET ACCESS

Suriname is a member of CARICOM and CARIFORUM and has been a WTO member, giving access to Caribbean regional markets and a framework for trade with Europe, alongside trade agreements with Brazil, Venezuela and Costa Rica. Gold dominates exports, accounting for about 80% of the total in 2023, with Switzerland (50.4%) and the United Arab Emirates (28.5%) the leading destinations, followed by Guyana and the United States. The Port of Paramaribo, Kuldipsingh Port and Johan Adolf Pengel International Airport are the main gateways, while land borders with Guyana and French Guiana link Suriname to a fast-growing regional energy economy and to the edge of the EU. From 2028, crude exports from GranMorgu will add a major new export stream and broaden the country's trading relationships.

## WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

### INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

| Actor | Why It Matters | Waverley Engagement Angle |
|---|---|---|
| Office of the President (Jennifer Geerlings-Simons) | President since 16 July 2025; sets economic policy, including the management of future oil revenues | Primary reference point for Suriname's strategic direction |
| Suriname Investment and Trade Agency (SITA) | National investment promotion agency and one-stop shop for foreign investors | Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentive guidance |
| Staatsolie Maatschappij Suriname | State oil company holding petroleum rights, a partner in GranMorgu and Block 52, and owner of 25% of the Merian gold mine | Essential counterpart for any energy or upstream engagement |
| Central Bank of Suriname (CBvS) | Monetary authority overseeing the Surinamese dollar, the foreign-exchange market and bank supervision | Relevant for currency, transfer and banking-sector matters |
| Savings and Stabilization Fund Suriname (SSFS) | Independently managed fund that will receive all mineral government revenue under the December 2024 law | Key to understanding how oil income will be saved and deployed |
| Ministry of Foreign Affairs, International Business and International Cooperation | Oversees SITA and leads trade diplomacy and international business relations | Relevant for bilateral partnerships and trade policy |
| Chamber of Commerce and Industry (KKF) | Company registry and main body for domestic business liaison | Useful for company formation and identifying local partners |

## CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry (KKF) is the main channel for company registration and domestic business liaison, and the Suriname-Guyana Chamber of Commerce supports cross-border business between two of the region's emerging energy economies. The annual Suriname Energy, Oil and Gas Summit (SEOGS), which added a Local Content Forum in 2026, is the leading gathering for the energy sector and its supply chain. SITA organises investor outreach and export promotion, while international operators such as TotalEnergies, Petronas and Newmont are useful sources of practical intelligence on supply-chain and local content opportunities. The Inter-American Development Bank and the IMF remain closely engaged on Suriname's macroeconomic and development agenda.

## INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Suriname suits investors with a medium-term horizon who want to position ahead of an oil-driven expansion: oilfield service, marine logistics and engineering firms targeting GranMorgu and Block 52 supply chains; mining and mining-services investors in the established gold sector and in bauxite; and infrastructure, construction and logistics investors meeting rising demand for port, housing and power capacity. Agribusiness, tourism and renewable energy investors can benefit from Investment Law incentives and CARICOM market access. All investors should plan for currency movements during the pre-oil period and give due weight to local partnerships and community engagement.

## FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage SITA and confirm Investment Law incentives
Open dialogue with the national investment promotion agency to confirm sector-specific tax holidays, duty exemptions and registration requirements.

STEP 2: Map oil and gas supply-chain opportunities
Engage Staatsolie and the GranMorgu and Block 52 operators to identify procurement needs ahead of first oil in 2028 and first gas targeted for 2030.

STEP 3: Build local partnerships and local content plans
Identify Surinamese partners through the KKF and SEOGS, and prepare for an evolving local content policy with training and supplier-development commitments.

STEP 4: Plan for currency and macroeconomic conditions
Build exchange-rate hedging and dollar-based contracting into project structures, and track IMF assessments and fiscal consolidation progress.

STEP 5: Strengthen due diligence and dispute-resolution protections
Conduct thorough counterparty and compliance checks and include international arbitration clauses, drawing on Suriname's New York Convention membership.